# 3 Assignment - OSINT

**4/6/2026**

**90/100** Points

Attempt 3

Review Feedback
4/4/2026

Attempt 3 Score:
**90/100**

View Feedback

Anonymous Grading: **no**

**4 Attempts Allowed**
3/26/2026 to 4/6/2026

**Details**

**Please don't upload the report on Github. Make a PDF and then upload to LMS only.**

Everyone.

Plz do submit the word / pdf document.

1. Do provide the details to which tools did you use.
2. If it was paid / credentials based, do share those creds in report. Otherwise that finding may be weak.
3. You may choose to use other tools of you see fit. But do mention the tool source and why did you use it to see fit.
4. Plz make sure it's a passive osint activity.

## Section 1 — Purpose & Ethics

## 1.1 What Is This Activity?

This is a supervised, consent-based Open Source Intelligence (OSINT) exercise. Your instructor has given explicit permission for you to research their publicly available digital footprint.

The goal is not to find private data — it is to discover what information is already publicly visible online, and to understand why that makes social engineering attacks so effective and so easy to launch.

## 1.2 What Is OSINT?

OSINT stands for Open Source Intelligence. It refers to the process of collecting and analysing information from publicly available sources — websites, social media, public records, leaked databases, and search engines.

Legitimate uses of OSINT include:

- Cybersecurity audits and penetration testing
- Journalism and investigative reporting
- Law enforcement and background verification
- Personal digital footprint audits (this activity)

## 1.3 Ethical Rules for This Exercise

Read and acknowledge the following rules before beginning. These are non-negotiable:

**1** You may only research the instructor — the consented target. Do not investigate any other person.

**2** Use only publicly available sources. Do not attempt to access any password-protected, private, or restricted data.

**3** Do not contact the instructor or any of their connections as part of your research.

**4** All findings remain strictly within the classroom. Do not share, post, or publish the instructor's information.

**5** The purpose is awareness — not exploitation. Any misuse of this activity is subject to academic and legal consequences under PECA 2016.

# Section 2 — Investigation Tools & Methodology

## 2.1 Where to Take Notes

Before you start searching, open a plain text Notepad file (or Notepad++ for better organisation) on your computer. Create the following structure at the top:

**=== OSINT INVESTIGATION NOTES ===**

Target Name: [instructor name]

Researcher: [your name]

Date: [today's date]

**==================================**

[TOOL USED] -> [FINDING] | Confidence: High / Medium / Low

[SOURCE URL]

*Keep one line per finding. Record the source URL for every piece of information — if you cannot cite a source, do not include it in your report.*

## 2.2 Investigation Tools — Step by Step

Work through the tools in the order listed. Each tool reveals a different layer of someone's digital footprint. Take notes in your Notepad file at each step.

### Tool 1 — Google Search (Start Here)

Google indexes an enormous amount of publicly shared information. Use these search techniques:

| Search Query | What You Are Looking For |
|---|---|
| "[Full Name]" | All indexed mentions across the web |
| "[Full Name]" site:linkedin.com | LinkedIn professional profile |
| "[Full Name]" site:facebook.com | Public Facebook presence |
| "[Full Name]" email | Publicly listed email addresses |
| "[Full Name]" Pakistan OR Lahore OR Karachi | Location-linked mentions |
| "[Full Name]" university OR professor OR lecturer | Academic / professional mentions |
| "[Full Name]" filetype:pdf | Published papers, CVs, conference proceedings |

"[Full Name]" -site:facebook.com -site:linkedin.com Mentions outside main social platforms

**Tool 2 — LinkedIn**

- Go to linkedin.com and search for the instructor's name.
- Note: Current role, employer, city, past positions, education, connections count.
- Check if they have written any posts, articles, or shared content publicly.
- Do NOT connect with or message the instructor as part of this exercise.

**Tool 3 — Hunter.io (Email Discovery)**

- Go to hunter.io — this tool finds professional email addresses linked to organisations.
- Enter the organisation domain (e.g. university website domain) to find associated emails.
- Use 'Email Finder' with the instructor's name + domain to look for a listed address.
- Note: Whether an email is found, the domain pattern, and confidence score.
- Free tier allows up to 25 searches per month — use it carefully.

**Tool 4 — Have I Been Pwned (HaveIBeenPwned.com)**

This tool checks whether an email address has appeared in a known data breach. If the instructor shares their email with you for this exercise, you can check it here.

- Go to haveibeenpwned.com
- Enter the email address in the search box.
- Note: Which breaches the address appeared in, what type of data was exposed, and the date.
- This tells you what attackers already know — not private data, but breach exposure.

**Tool 5 — Reverse Image Search (Google Images / TinEye)**

- Find a publicly visible photo of the instructor (LinkedIn, university website, etc.).
- Go to images.google.com, click the camera icon, and upload or paste the image URL.
- Alternatively use tineye.com for a different index.
- Note: Where else that photo appears, whether the same face appears under different names.

**Tool 6 — WhatsMyName.app**

- Go to whatsmyname.app
- Enter the instructor's first + last name (or a known username).
- This tool checks hundreds of platforms simultaneously for matching usernames.
- Note: Which platforms show a profile match and whether the profile is public.

**Tool 7 — Pipl / Spokeo (People Search Engines)**

- Pipl (pipl.com) and Spokeo (spokeo.com) aggregate public records.
- Search by name. Note any public professional information that appears.
- These tools operate differently in Pakistan — results may be limited or unavailable.
- Note findings or note 'No results found' — both are valid observations.

**Tool 8 — AI Research Assistant (ChatGPT / Gemini / Claude)**

Use an AI tool to help synthesise and enrich what you have already found. Do NOT ask the AI to invent information.

- Paste your notes so far and ask: 'Based on this publicly available information, what kind of person profile can be constructed?'
- Ask: 'What social engineering attacks could a malicious actor launch using this information?'
- Ask: 'What specific phishing email or vishing script could be built from these details?'

*The AI output here is for analysis only — it should synthesise what you found, not add new facts.*

**Tool 9 — University / Organisation Website**

- Visit the instructor's university or employer website.
- Check the staff/faculty directory — name, department, room number, phone, email.
- Look for listed courses, research interests, office hours.
- Check for a personal academic page or Google Scholar profile.

**Tool 10 — Google Dorks (Advanced)**

Google Dorks are advanced search operators that surface information Google normally buries. Try these:

| Dork Query | What It Finds |
|---|---|
| intitle:"[Name]" filetype:pdf | PDFs with name in document title |
| inurl:"[Name]" site:ac.pk | Pakistani .ac.pk academic pages |
| "[Name]" intext:email OR phone | Contact details in page body text |
| "[Name]" site:researchgate.net | Research publications |
| "[Name]" site:github.com | Code repositories or contributions |
| "[Name]" site:youtube.com | Video content or channel |

# Section 3 — Investigation Notes

Complete the following tables as you research. Write short, factual notes. Every entry must have a source. Write 'Not found' if a tool returns no results — that is a valid and important finding.

## 3.1 Identity & Contact Information

| Data Point | Finding Source URL / Tool |
|---|---|
| Full Name | |
| Known Aliases / Usernames | |
| Professional Email Address | |
| Personal Email Address | |
| Phone Number (if public) | |
| City / Location | |
| Profile Photo Found? | |

## 3.2 Professional & Academic Profile

| Data Point | Finding Source URL / Tool |
|---|---|
| Current Employer / University | |
| Job Title / Role | |
| Department | |
| Past Employers | |
| Education Background | |
| Research Interests | |
| Published Papers / Work | |

| | |
|---|---|
| LinkedIn URL | |
| Other Social Media Profiles | |

## 3.3 Digital Presence & Breach Exposure

| Data Point | Finding Source URL / Tool |
|---|---|
| Platforms Found On (WhatsMyName) | |
| Username Pattern Observed | |
| Data Breach Exposure (HIBP) | |
| Breach Names & Data Types | |
| Photo Appears On (TinEye / Reverse) | |
| GitHub / Code Presence | |
| YouTube / Media Presence | |
| Any Leaked Documents Found? | |

## 4.1 Report Structure

Your submitted report must follow this structure exactly:

| # Section | What to Include |
|---|---|
| 1 **Title Page** | Subject, Student Name, ID, Date, Target Name, Ethical Acknowledgement |
| 2 **Executive Summary** | 2–3 sentences: what you found, what risk level it represents |
| 3 **Methodology** | Which tools you used, in which order, and how long spent on each |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 4 | **Findings Table** | All data points found — copied from Section 3 of this worksheet |
| 5 | **Most Dangerous Finding** | One paragraph on the most critical piece of information found |
| 6 | **Recommendations** | What should the instructor change or remove from public access? |
| 7 | **Reflection** | What did this exercise teach you about your own digital footprint? |
| 8 | **Sources** | List every URL and tool used, with the finding it supported |

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## Section 5 — Grading Rubric

Your report will be graded on the following criteria. Maximum score: 100 marks.

| Criterion | Description | Marks | Score |
|---|---|---|---|
| Depth of Research | Number of tools used, effort shown, variety of sources found | 45 | |
| Accuracy & Citation | All findings backed by verifiable sources, no fabricated data | 20 | |
| Recommendations | Specific, actionable advice personalised to the findings | 15 | |
| Report Structure | Follows the required format, professional tone, clear writing | 10 | |
| Reflection | Depth of personal insight — what did you learn about exposure? | 10 | |
| **Total** | | **100** | |

Lastly, after doing everything, you need to perform OSINT on your own self.

| | File Name | Size | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | hw3-1.pdf | 248 KB | Download (https://hulms.instructure.com/files/819550/download?download_frd=1&verifier=yuVJFh04nYtUZWlWrY2tFQQJcej5kz6e3Mi5djFT) |

(https://hulms.instructure.com/courses/4979/modules/items/182841) (https://hulms.instructure.com/courses/4979/modu

*You are unable to submit to this assignment as your enrollment in this course has been concluded.*